

Word Problems – Real Life Maths

Planrs Academy



Learning Goal



Today you will learn to
solve maths problems
hidden inside stories!



Hook & Engagement



Meera wants 7 mangoes,
Rohan wants 5 more. How
many mangoes
altogether?



Quick Warm-Up – Just Numbers!

01

$$6 + 7 = ?$$

02

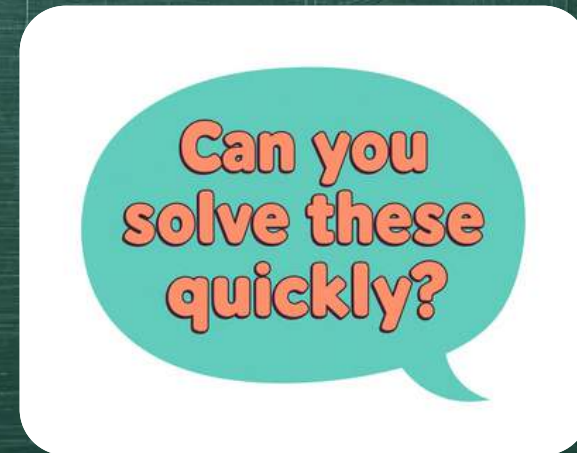
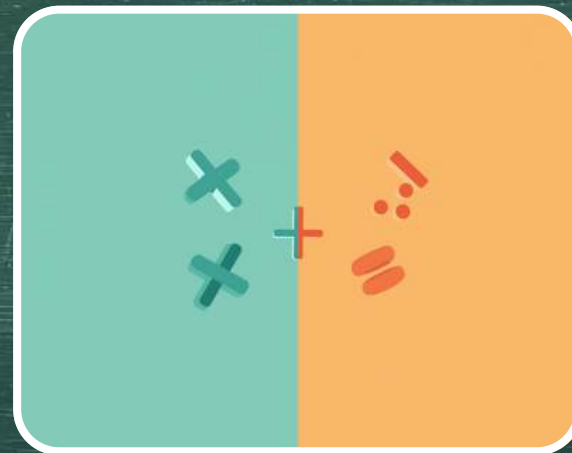
$$15 - 8 = ?$$

03

$$9 + 4 = ?$$

04

$$12 - 5 = ?$$



Four-Step Framework

UNDERSTAND

"What is the story telling me?"



PLAN

"What maths do I need to do?"



SOLVE

"Let me work it out."



CHECK

"Does my answer make sense in the story?"



Mango Problem Walkthrough

01

UNDERSTAND
7 and 5, find
total



02

PLAN
"Altogether"
means ADD →
 $7 + 5$



03

SOLVE
 $7 + 5 = 12$
mangoes!



04

CHECK
12 is more than
7, makes
sense!



Clue Words Reference Card

ADDITION

- altogether
- total
- in all
- more than
- plus
- sum
- combined
- both
- how many in all
- added



SUBTRACTION

- left
- remaining
- fewer
- took away
- spent
- gave away
- difference
- less than
- how many more




$$+1=$$

Clue Word Spotter!

"Priya has 9 bangles. She got 4 more. How many altogether?"

Spot the clues:

- "more" → ADD ✓
- "altogether" → ADD ✓

Which math operation will you use?



Clue Word Spotter

"There were 18 idlis. The family ate 7. How many are left?"

Clues: "ate" and "left" =
SUBTRACT

Which math operation will
you use?



Modelled Example 1 – Diwali Chaklis



01

UNDERSTAND

Numbers: 13 and 6

Question: How many in all?



02

PLAN

"In all" means ADD

$13 + 6$



03

SOLVE

$13 + 6 = 19$



04

CHECK

19 is more than 13

Makes sense! ✓



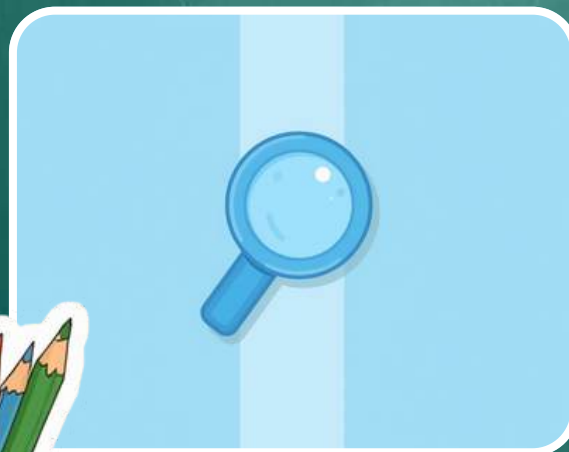
Modelled Example 2 – Arjun's Pencils

01

UNDERSTAND

Numbers: 17 and 5

Question: How many now?



02

PLAN

"Lost" means

SUBTRACT

$17 - 5$



03

SOLVE

$17 - 5 = 12$

Work it out!



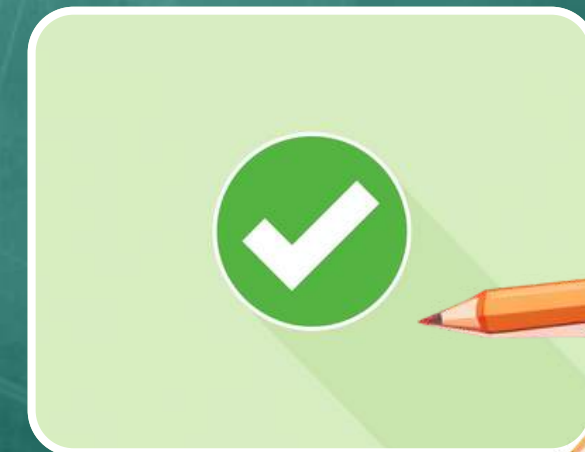
04

CHECK

12 is less than 17

Answer: 12

pencils ✓



Guided Practice 1

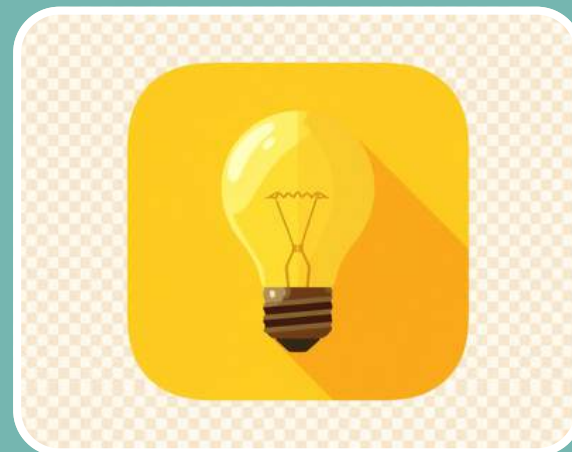
UNDERSTAND

What numbers do I see? What is the question asking?



PLAN

Which operation?
Add or Subtract?



SOLVE

Work it out!



CHECK

Does my answer
make sense?



Guided Practice 2 – Bazaar Fruits

UNDERSTAND

Numbers: ___ and ___
Question: _____

PLAN

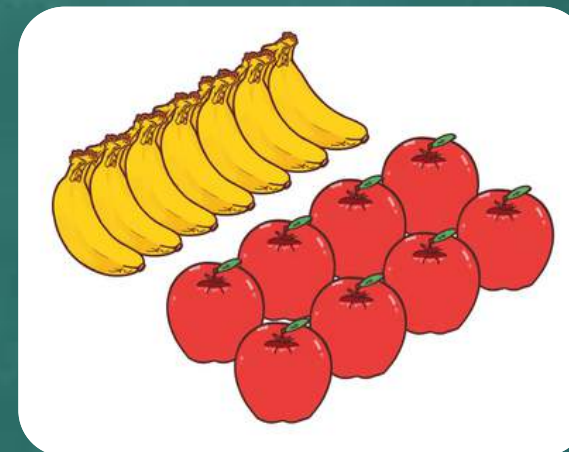
Clue word: _____
Operation: _____

SOLVE

___ ○ ___ = ___

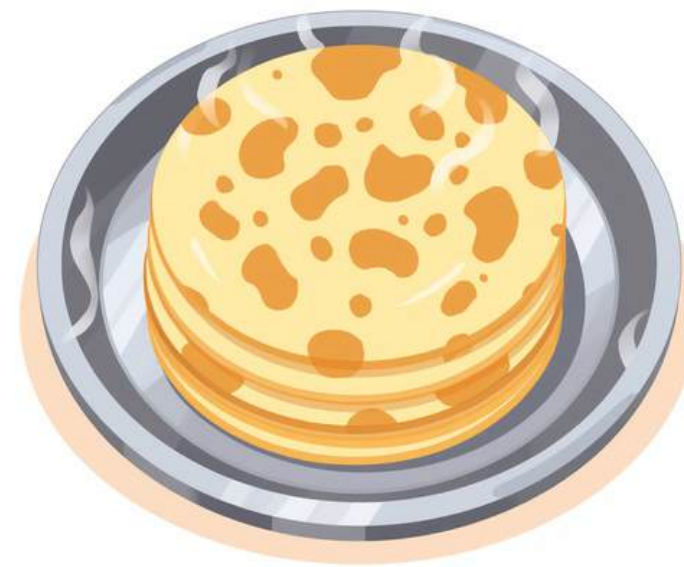
CHECK

Does ___ make sense?
Answer: ___ fruits



Independent Practice 1

Amma cooked 20 chapatis for dinner. The family ate 13 chapatis. How many chapatis were left?
Solve this on your own!



Independent Practice 2

There are 11 girls and 7 boys
in Kavya's class today. How
many children are in the
class altogether?
Solve this on your own!



Today We Learned...



STORY = MATHS

✓ A word problem is a story with maths hidden inside!



CLUE WORDS

✓ Clue words tell us: ADD or SUBTRACT



4 STEPS

✓ UNDERSTAND → PLAN → SOLVE → CHECK



UNITS!

✓ Always write your answer with a UNIT/LABEL

Exit Ticket Quiz

Riya had 16 stickers. She gave 7 to her friend.

Circle the right number sentence:

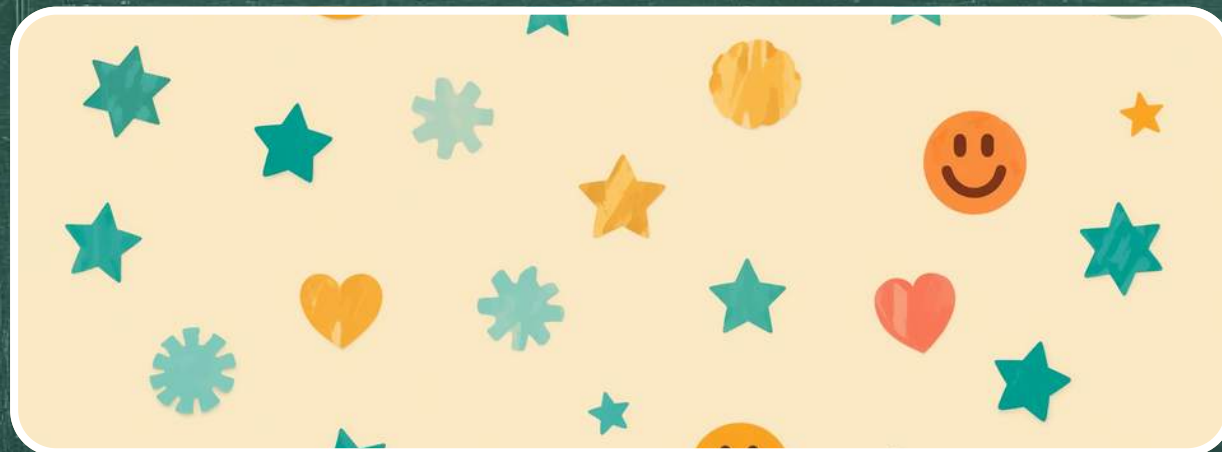
A) $16 + 7 = 23$

B) $16 - 7 = 9$ ✓

C) $7 - 16 = ?$

D) $16 + 16 = 32$

Correct Answer: B



Home Challenge



Can you write YOUR OWN
word problem tonight
using something that
happened in your home?
Bring it to class tomorrow
and we'll solve it together!



Making Maths Magical
Every child sees
themselves in our content
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